



"Disillusionment is a big deterrent for youth"

FARHAN AKHTAR FILM
PRODUCER, DIRECTOR, ACTOR

I don't know how many people here really know my father but I think he is an extremely young person and he is in his 60s. It's the way you think, it's your idea, your outlook on life that makes you young or old. As far as talking about the self-obsessed young generation, I think it's important for people to want a better life for themselves. It's important again for your growth but saying which, I think when we talk about people in office, in Parliament, they have been there for so many years and there really hasn't been much change. There is disillusionment with the system that we live in. The big question is what can we do to make young people feel non-disillusioned? As a filmmaker, I can try when a story touches me like the way the stories of soldiers in Kargil moved me to make a film about them, but I don't want to confuse films with social messages. Filmmakers need to be protected so that we can then bravely tell stories you want told. This kind of vigilante action where people take law into their own hands and decide what is right for the people to watch and what's not right is something that needs addressing. I think that's more or less everything I need to say here but again, just as a filmmaker and somebody who is considered young, I do want to be a part of this change, I do hope to be a part of this change, I do try to be part of this change but I think the biggest problem for me is the disillusionment that a lot of young people feel.

"To change the world, change ourselves"

ABHINAV BINDRA ACE SHOOTER

I thought I would tell you about the experience that changed my life. When I was 17 years old, I went to the 2000 Sydney Olympic Games. I suddenly realised how big the world is and as a competitor I believed, or decided, that I wanted to take on the world. I wanted to beat everybody. I wanted to be the best. Until 2008, no Indian athlete had ever stood by him-



HEMANT CHAWLA

self on top of the podium in an Olympic stadium. I wanted to change that. But I believe that to change the world, we must be prepared to change ourselves. I was prepared to be changed. In August 2008, I realised the dream I first had as a 17-year-old. This dream only came true after a training regime that stopped at nothing in terms of effort and organisation. Sport is a microcosm of a nation, and part of building our reputation on the global stage is succeeding in the global sporting arena. India does not recognise this. We need to change our attitude towards sport. Sport is not a casual activity. Sport is not an opportunity for an administrator or a politician to further his own ambitions. In order for us to showcase ourselves successfully, I have four ideas about what must change. First, we need to identify sporting talent in our country. Second, we need to raise our expectations. Third, we need to put our athletes first. In India, the athlete does not always come first. This needs to change. Fourth, we need to plan ahead. Indian athletes are not supported by long-term planning, and this needs to change.

What it needs is a larger vision, a sense of ownership, a sense of responsibility, particularly on the part of those who occupy positions of power, those with resources at their disposal. If we do not make changes for the better, change will happen for the worse. We need to change sport in India. And if we do it well, it can provide inspiration to other areas.

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